

INTERACTIVE RCM AUDIT • 2026

The 2026 RCM Self-Diagnostic Matrix For US Billing Leaders

Swipe through this 90-second diagnostic to identify exactly where your billing agency or clinic is bleeding cash—and how the India + AI model recovers 65% operating margin.

01

Pre-Submission Scrubbing

Are clearinghouses catching your errors before you do?

02

Labor Unit Economics

Is \$45/hr US coder payroll capping your EBITDA at 16%?

03

Autonomous Routing

Are 90% of routine claims clearing with zero manual touches?

DIAGNOSTIC LEVEL 01

Where Does Your Scrubbing Happen?

Payers use algorithmic denial bots to reject claims in milliseconds. Check your current workflow below to find your vulnerability score:

LEVEL 1: BASIC CLEARINGHOUSE
HIGH RISK

Post-Submission Clearinghouse Edits Only

Claims sent directly to Availity/Change. 12% to 15% bounce back as 277CA rejections. Billers spend 48 hours manually researching CARC codes.

COST: \$43.84 rework cost per claim • High write-off risk
LEVEL 2: MANUAL SPOT CHECKS
MARGIN SQUEEZE

In-House Certified Coders Reviewing Every Chart

High accuracy, but bottlenecks turnaround time to 5+ days. US billers spend 80% of their time on routine data checks instead of working denials.

COST: \$85,000/yr per FTE • Stalls agency client expansion
LEVEL 3: AETHERA AUTONOMOUS NEURAL ENGINE
OPTIMAL

Pre-Submission AI Intercept + Global Pods

Rules graph evaluates NCCI, LCD/NCD, and modifier combinations in <250ms BEFORE clearinghouse transmission. Certified India pod handles complex 10%.

RESULT: 99.1% First-Pass Clean Claims • 65% Lower Cost

DIAGNOSTIC LEVEL 02

The Labor Unit Economics Squeeze

Compare the true fully loaded annual cost of staffing an RCM back office across the three existing delivery models in 2026:

US In-House FTE	Legacy Indian BPO	Aethera India + AI
\$88,400 Fully Loaded / Year	\$32,000 Annual Per Seat	\$29,500 Delivered Pod / Year
Hourly Wage \$42 / hr	Hourly Basis Manual Keying	Hourly Basis AI-Augmented
Taxes & Benefits +28% overhead	Error Rate 14% - 18% error	Credentials AAPC / AHIMA
Annual Churn 38% (high)	Turnover High churn	Turnover Zero downtime
Clean Claim SLA None (Internal)	Clean Claim SLA 85% avg	Clean Claim SLA 99.1% Guaranteed
Agency EBITDA Capped at 16%	Tech Stack Zero AI Tools	Agency EBITDA 40%+ Unlocked

DIAGNOSTIC LEVEL 03

The Autonomous Claim Decision Tree

How Aethera routes 100% of your agency's charges to achieve sub-12 hour turnaround with 99.1% clean accuracy:

01

INCOMING 837P CHARGE

Direct ingestion from AthenaHealth, Epic, eCW, or AdvancedMD

02

AETHERA NEURAL SCRUBBER (<250ms)

Instant NCCI PTP validation, LCD/NCD coverage check & modifier 25/59 matching

90%

BRANCH A: 90% ROUTINE CLAIMS

Cleared autonomously with zero human intervention -> Direct to Clearinghouse

10%

BRANCH B: 10% COMPLEX EXCEPTIONS

Surgical notes & appeals routed to dedicated AAPC Pod in India -> Resolved overnight

03

REAL-TIME 835 REMITTANCE DEFENSE

CARC/RARC denial parsed; auto-generates clinical appeal dossiers with evidence

YOUR NEXT ACTION STEP

Put the India + AI Model to Work

Test your agency's numbers right now on our live interactive web tools, or put our team to work on 50 of your denied claims:

INTERACTIVE CALCULATOR

Calculate Your Operating Margin Unlock

Simulate your agency's exact savings based on your US biller headcount and hourly rate.

TOOL: aetherahealthcare.com/for-billing-companies#interactive-calculator

LIVE SCRUBBING TOOL

Run an Instant Clean-Claim Benchmark

Test your specialty codes against our 2026 NCCI bundling & LCD coverage matrix.

TOOL: aetherahealthcare.com/tools/clean-claim-scorecard

RISK-FREE PILOT

Complimentary 50-Claim Back-Office Pilot

Send 50 denied or aging claims. We scrub, draft appeals, and prove cash recovery in 14 days.

TOOL: aetherahealthcare.com/free-assessment?intent=partner_pilot